



Shop Act MH: 104297592503
Udyam: UDYAM-MH-26-0889139

BON VOYAGE BY MARINA

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All-Inclusive Japan Travel Guide

Destinations: Tokyo • Mt. Fuji • Kyoto • Osaka • Nara
Duration: May 16 – May 27



Day-Wise Itinerary with Recommendations



Day 1: Friday, May 16 — Arrival in Tokyo & Harry Potter Magic

Hotel: [Richmond Hotel Premier Tokyo Schole](#) | 1 hr 11 min distance by public transport from the airport

Evening Plan:

- [Asakasa Plaza](#): Spot the **world's largest Time Turner**
 Opening hours - 11:00 am - 9:00 pm | 41 min distance by public transport
- [Harry Potter Café](#): ⚡ Wizard-themed treats | 🚶 2 min walk
- [Akasaka ACT Theatre](#): Enjoy the live production *Harry Potter and the Cursed Child* | 🚶 2 min walk

Dinner Recommendations (near your hotel):

1. [Kailash Asian Dining and Bar](#) – Indian Cuisine | Vegetarian-Friendly
💰 ₹700–₹1400 | 11 am–10:30 pm | 🚶 5 min
2. [Tenku Lounge TOP of TREE](#) – Continental Cuisine | Skytree View | Must-try ambience
💰 ₹1400–₹2100 | 5–11 pm | 🚶 2 min

Dinner Recommendations (near your Asakasa Plaza):

1. [Ninja Akasaka](#) – Themed Dining | Japanese and International Dishes with Ninja Presentation | Unique Experience
💰 ₹4,000 - ₹8,000 | 5 pm–10 pm (Sun), 5 pm–4 am (Mon-Fri), 5 pm–10 pm (Sat)
| 🚶 Approximately 15-20 minutes walk



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2.  [Nataraj Aoyama Indian Restaurant](#) – *Indian Cuisine | Wide Variety of Vegetarian Dishes | Authentic Spices*
 ₹2,000 - ₹4,000 |  11 am–3 pm, 5 pm–11 pm |  Approximately 15-20 minutes walk



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Day 2: Saturday, May 17 — Temples & Tech in Tokyo

Morning:

- [Senso-ji Temple](#)

Tokyo's oldest temple. It is the temple of Avalokitesvara Bodhisattva (Sho Kanzeon Bosatsu), who embodies the mercy of all Buddhas.

 Opening hours - 06:00 am to 5:00 pm |  14 min distance by public transport

- [Asakusa](#)

-  7 min from Senso-ji Temple
- Visit the Asakusa Culture and Sightseeing Center located opposite of the Kaminarimon.
- The 8th-floor observation terrace offers a nice view of Asakusa and Tokyo Sky Tree. It is free and open from 10 am to 8 pm.
- People typically spend about an hour for the whole experience
- There are several small food shops available, as well as experiential sit down restaurants and even Ninja cafes!
- If you are spending more time in Asakusa, you may also want to do the following:
 - View the [The Asahi Beer Tower and Asahi Super Dry Hall](#) with its characteristic Flamme d'Or were completed in 1989 and host the headquarters of Asahi Breweries. Furthermore, several restaurants can be found in the complex. Restaurants open 11:30 to 15:00 and 17:30 to 22:00. Behind both the Beer Tower and the Super Dry Hall is the Asahi Craftmanship Brewery. The restaurant and brewery offers diners decently priced lunches as well as Asahi craft beer on tap.
 - Visit [Sumida Park](#)- This riverside park stretches along both sides of Sumida River for several hundred meters
 - Visit iconic restaurants/bars/cafes such as [Kamiya Bar](#) (one of Japan's oldest bars, with a history reaching back to 1880), [Umezono](#) (a traditional Japanese sweets shop that started in 1854. Their menu contains classics like anmitsu and oshiruko in addition to seasonal favorites like shaved ice (kakigori) and [Asakusa Kagetsudo](#)- a melon-pan store and restaurant that has been in business since 1945
 - Else check the restaurant list for options in Akihabara



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Midday:

- 🎮 [Akihabara](#): Explore anime stores & Harry Potter merch.
- 🕒 Opening hours - 10:00 am - 8:00 pm | 🚶 18 min distance by public transport
 - It has hundreds of electronics shops, ranging from tiny one-man stalls specializing in a particular electronic component to large electronics retailers, line the main Chuo Dori street
 - The only mega sized store is the [Yodobashi Camera](#) complex on the east side of the station.
 - There are also dozens of stores specializing in anime, manga, retro video games, figurines, card games and other collectibles that have filled the spaces between the electronics retailers.
 - The Akihabara branch of Don Quijote is home to the girl pop group AKB48, who perform daily shows at their theater on the 8th floor of the store

Evening:

- 🖼️ [teamLab Planets](#)

A digital art museum known for its immersive and interactive exhibits that blur the lines between art and technology. Wander through rooms where artworks flow into each other, creating a continuous and ever-changing landscape.

🕒 Opening hours - 09:00 am to 10:00 pm | 🚶 40 min distance by public transport

🍽️ Lunch Options in Akihabara (All Vegetarian-Friendly):

- 🍛 [Zeera Akihabara](#) – Indian | Good for vegetarians
💰 ₹700–₹1200 | 🕒 11 am–3 pm / 5–11 pm
- 🍜 [Gyumon Halal Ramen](#) – Ramen | Vegetarian Options Available
💰 ₹1200–₹1800 | 🕒 12–10 pm
- 🥟 [Gyoza Bar Keisuke](#) – Dumplings | Vegetarian + Vegan-friendly
💰 ₹700–₹1400 | 🕒 6 am–2 pm (Closed Mon/Tues)

🍽️ Dinner Recommendations (near teamLab Planets):

- 🍜 Vegan Ramen UZU Tokyo – Vegan Ramen | Art-Surrounded Dining | Unique Flavors



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💰 ₹1,400 - ₹2,800 | 🕒 10:30 am – 8:30 pm (Ramen last order 8 pm) | 🚶 Located within teamLab Planets

2. 🇮🇳 [Asian Dining Darima Toyosu](#) – *Indian Cuisine | Vegetarian Menu Available | All-You-Can-Eat & Drink Options*

💰 ₹1,100 - ₹3,300 | 🕒 Lunch: 11 am – 3 pm, Dinner: 6 pm – 11 pm | 🚶 Approximately 15-20 minutes walk

3. 🍔 [MOS Burger LaLaport Toyosu](#) – *Burger Chain | Vegetarian Soy Patty Options | Casual Dining*

💰 ₹500 - ₹1,000 | 🕒 Hours vary by location | 🚶 Approximately 5-10 minutes walk (located in LaLaport Toyosu)



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Day 3: Sunday, May 18 — Tokyo's Trendiest Districts

Morning:

-  [Shibuya Scramble Crossing](#)

It is known for its iconic scramble crossing and Hachiko statue

 Opening hours - 10:00 am to 9:00 pm |  39 min distance by public transport

-  [Harajuku](#)

It is the iconic district of youth fashion. Harajuku is famous for being the epicenter of Japanese youth culture, fashion, and subculture in Tokyo.

 Opening hours - 11:00 am to 8:00 pm |  16 min distance by public transport

Midday Food Crawl in Shibuya (All Veg-Friendly or Sweets):

1.  [I'm Donut?](#) – Signature: mochi-style chewy donuts
 11 am–8 pm | 💰 Not specified
2.  [Le Souffle](#) – Must-try: Signature soufflé cakes
 11 am–5:30 pm | 💰 ₹800–₹1200
3.  [Maccha House](#) – Uji Matcha drinks & desserts
 11 am–7 pm | 💰 ₹700–₹1200

Evening:

-  [Harajuku & Takeshita Street](#)

Dinner Options:

1.  [Maidreamin Shibuya](#) – Cosplay Café | Unique Experience
💰 ₹800–₹1400 |  Till 11 pm
2.  [Tokyu Food Show](#) – Multiple food stalls under one roof
💰 ₹600–₹2000 |  Till 11 pm



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3.  **Ruru Shibuya** – *Modern café with water table concept*
 ₹700–₹1200 |  11 am–8:30 pm
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Day 4: Monday, May 19 — Warner Bros. Studio & Ueno Park

- [Warner Bros. Studio Tour](#)

Immerse yourself in the behind-the-scenes magic of the Harry Potter films. Enjoy the themed food and shopping within the studio tour

 Opening hours - 8:30 am to 7:00 pm |  1 hr 7 min distance by public transport

- [Ueno Park](#)

Ueno Park is one of Japan's five oldest public parks. It's best known for Ueno Zoo, many museums, and spectacular cherry blossoms in the spring.

 Opening hours - 5:00 am to 11:00 pm |  51 min distance by public transport

Dinner Options (Ueno area):

1.  [Inshotei](#) – Japanese Kaiseki | Reservation Required | Premium Experience
 ₹2500–₹4000 |  5–9 pm
 2.  [Everyones Cafe](#) – International café with cheesecake and sandwiches
 ₹800–₹1400 |  Till 9 pm
 3.  [Ichiran Asakusa](#) – Famous Solo Ramen Dining | Ask for “no pork” options
 ₹900–₹1400 |  10 am–10 pm
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Day 5: Tuesday, May 20 — Mt. Fuji Day Trip

 Includes:

-  [Chureito Pagoda](#)

Chureito (five-storied pagoda) is a memorial pagoda for the war dead located in Arakurayama Sengen Park. Its beautiful five-storied pagoda and panoramic views of Mt. Fuji are famous in Japan and abroad, and it is a spot visited by many tourists.

- [Oshino Hakkai](#)

Oshino Hakkai was designated by the Japanese government as a Natural Monument in 1934 and selected by the present Ministry of Environment as one of the 100 Best Water Sources of Japan in 1985. All of the ponds are component parts of the “Fujisan, sacred place and source of artistic inspiration” World Heritage site.

- [Kitaguchi hongo shrine](#)

This beautiful shrine is located at the foot of Mount Fuji, making it a must-visit for anyone traveling to Japan.

-  [Lake Kawaguchiko](#)

Lake Kawaguchi is a beautiful place in Kawaguchi City, Japan, famous for its amazing views of Mount Fuji.

 Eat local: Try **Hoto Noodles** (flat noodles in miso broth) or **vegetable ramen** around Kawaguchiko.

- [Mt Kachi kachi ropeway](#)

This ropeway can be ridden from the shores of Lake Kawaguchi. Mt. Tenjo is said to be where the Japanese folktale, “Kachi-kachi Yama,” took place, hence the name of the ropeway. The ropeway takes three minutes to reach the top, 1,075 meters above sea level.

- [Oishi park](#)

Oishi Park, located on the shore of Lake Kawaguchi in Japan, is a popular destination known for its stunning views of Mount Fuji and the surrounding scenery. The park features a variety of flowers throughout the seasons.



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Day 6: Wednesday, May 21 — Kyoto Arrival & Scenic Sights

 Bullet Train to Kyoto

 Train timing - 11am- 13:15 |  2 hr 51 min distance by public transport

 [Richmond Hotel Premier Kyoto Ekimae](#)

 6 minutes walk from the Kyoto station

Sightseeing:

-  [Arashiyama Bamboo Grove](#)

The Bamboo Forest, Arashiyama Bamboo Grove, or Sagano Bamboo Forest is a natural bamboo forest in Arashiyama, Kyoto, Japan. It consists mostly of mōsō bamboo and has several pathways for tourists and visitors.

 Opening hours - 24 hrs a day |  52 min distance by public transport

-  [Gion District](#)

Gion is known as the city's entertainment district, particularly for the refined performers known as geisha (or more properly geiko) who have enthralled patrons for centuries, Gion is full of handsome, understated townhouses and teahouses, restaurants serving traditional Kyoto cuisine, and venerable temples and shrines.

 Opening hours - 10:00 am to 6:00 pm |  2 hr 54 min distance by public transport

 Dinner Recommendations (All Walkable):

1.  [Gohan-ya](#) – Home-style Japanese | Seasonal menu | Alcohol options
 ₹1000–₹1600 |  5:30–10:30 pm
 2.  [Kyo Chabana Kyoto Station](#) – Okonomiyaki Specialty | Vegetarian Options
 ₹1400–₹2100 |  5–10:30 pm
 3.  [Sushi No Musashi](#) – Conveyor belt sushi | Budget-friendly
 ₹1000–₹1800 |  10:30 am–9:20 pm
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Day 7: Thursday, May 22 — Universal Studios Japan

[Universal Studios Osaka](#)

 Explore The Wizarding World of Harry Potter, ride the Hogwarts Express, sip Butterbeer, and wander through the cobbled lanes of Hogsmeade. Also, don't miss Mario Kart and Minion Park!

Universal Studio Japan is a great place! It's really huge, so make sure to eat a big breakfast and arrive early to make the most of your day.

 Opening hours - 9:00 am–9:00 pm | 💰 Full-day ticket ~₹5400 | 🚆 1 hr by public transport from Kyoto

Dinner Recommendations (Back in Kyoto):

1.  [Menya Yukou](#) – Vegetarian-friendly ramen, flavourful broths
 5:30–10:00 pm | 💰 ₹900–₹1400 | 🚶 2 min
 2.  [Pastamore Kyoto Station Store](#) – Comforting Italian pastas
 11:00 am–9:00 pm | 💰 ₹800–₹1200
 3.  [Taj Mahal Everest Karasuma Oike](#) – Vegetarian/vegan Indian menu
 11:00 am–3:00 pm, 5:00–10:00 pm | 💰 ₹800–₹1200
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Day 8: Friday, May 23 — Osaka Day Trip: Castles & Street Food

 Train to Osaka (50 min)

Morning–Afternoon:

 [Osaka Castle](#): Climb to the top for panoramic views and learn about Japan's samurai legacy.

Osaka Castle is arguably Osaka's most prominent landmark and belies bloody power struggles leading up to the 1603 foundation of the Edo era. While its history dates back to 1583, the landmark main tower that is the castle's icon was only re-constructed in 1931

 Opening hours - 9:00 am–5:00 pm |  30 min distance by public transport

Evening:

 [Dotonbori](#): Osaka's electric nightlife epicenter. Don't miss the Glico sign, takoyaki stalls, and retro photo booths. Ideal for a walking food tour.

Dotonbori, located along the canal of the same name, is a street in the Namba district of Osaka's Chuo ward that epitomizes the city's nightlife. The colorful area is an explosion of neon lights, mouth watering street food, retro vibes, clubs, stores, and bars.

 Opening hours - 24 hrs a day |  36 min distance by public transport

Dinner Recommendations in Dotonbori:

-  [Shama Vegetarian Indian Restaurant](#) – **Fully vegetarian menu**, cozy interiors
 5:00–10:00 pm | 💰 ₹800–₹1400
-  [Singhs Kitchen](#) – North Indian favorites, reliable for vegetarians
 10:00 am–10:00 pm | 💰 ₹900–₹1500
-  [Green Earth](#) – **Vegan Japanese & English menu**, curry & rice sets
 Till 5:00 pm (closes earlier, so great for early dinner or snack) | 💰 ₹800–₹1200

 Return to Kyoto for the night.



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Day 9: Saturday, May 24 — Temples of Kyoto

Morning:

 [Kinkaku-ji \(Golden Pavilion\):](#)

A glittering Zen temple set on a pond. Absolutely photogenic. It is also known as the Golden Pavilion, a stunning Zen temple covered in gold leaf. The pavilion was later designated a World Heritage Site in 1994 due to its spectacular architecture that uniquely harmonizes the culture and prevailing design of court nobles, samurai, and Buddhism.

 9:00 am–5:00 pm |  36 min distance by public transport

Afternoon:

 [Kiyomizu-dera Temple:](#) A UNESCO site with sweeping valley views, seasonal blooms, and a sacred waterfall.

Kiyomizudera prides itself on presenting views unique to each season. Hillsides blanketed with cherry blossoms in spring, the verdant green of summer, delicate trees in winter, and autumn colors in fall.

 6:00 am–6:00 pm |  1 hr 8 min distance by public transport

Evening:

 [Fushimi Inari Taisha:](#) Walk through thousands of orange torii gates, especially magical when lit after sunset.

It is famous for its thousands of red torii gates which are beautifully lantern-lit in the evening. Dedicated to Inari, the deity of a good harvest and success in business, Fushimi Inari Taisha is the head of all of Japan's Inari shrines. The seemingly endless path of vibrant orange torii gates that line the approach to Mt. Inari makes for an impressive setting and is one of the most famous images of Japan.

 Opening Hours - 24 hrs |  36 min distance by public transport

Dinner Nearby (Fushimi Inari):

-  [Restaurant Namaste](#) – Indian/Nepali food, **vegetarian-friendly**
 11:00 am–10:00 pm | 💰 ₹800–₹1200
-  [New Annapurna Fukakusa](#) – Indian, near shrine, good veg selection
 11:00 am–3:00 pm / 5:00–11:00 pm | 💰 ₹800–₹1200

Day 10: Sunday, May 25 — Nara Day Trip



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Morning–Afternoon:

 [Nara Park](#): Feed and photograph tame deer freely roaming the park. The area around Nara Park is known for its incredible cultural heritage

 Opening Hours - 24 hrs |  1 hr 24 min distance by public transport

 [Todai-ji Temple](#): Home to Japan's largest bronze Buddha.

 Opening Hours - 7:30 am–5:30 pm |  1 min

Evening (Back in Kyoto):

 Participate in a traditional tea ceremony—many cultural centers near Gion or Nishiki offer 1-hour immersive experiences.

Dinner Suggestions:

1.  [Gohan-ya](#) – Homestyle Japanese with sake pairings
 2.  [Spice Lounge](#) – **Vegetarian-friendly Indian dishes**
 Till 11:00 pm |  ₹1200–₹1800
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Day 11: Monday, May 26 — Art & Shopping in Osaka

 [MinaLima Osaka art gallery](#): See original graphic designs used in the Harry Potter & Fantastic Beasts movies.

 11:00 am–9:00 pm |  1 hr 42 min from Kyoto

 Spend the rest of the day shopping at department stores like Takashimaya, Uniqlo, Loft, or Tokyu Hands.



Dinner Suggestions (Back in Kyoto):

-  [Mr. Maurice's Italian Restaurant and Bar](#) – Cozy, wood-fired pizzas
 5:30–9:30 pm |  ₹1200–₹2000
-  [Kosa – New American Restaurant](#) – Upscale, creative fare
 5:30–10:00 pm



Day 12: Tuesday, May 27 — Departure from Osaka

 Sayonara, Japan! Depart from Osaka Kansai International Airport.



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Must-Try Restaurants & Cafés in Tokyo

1. [Tenku Lounge TOP of TREE](#)

 Tokyo Solamachi

 **Why Go:** Dine on the 31st floor with **panoramic Skytree views**.

 Continental cuisine | 💰 ₹1400–₹2100 | ⌚ 11 am–4 pm / 5–11 pm

 Vegetarian-friendly: Limited but available.

2. [Gyoza Bar Keisuke](#)

 Asakusa

 **Why Go:** Renowned for handmade dumplings; **vegan options available**.

💰 ₹700–₹1400 | ⌚ 6 am–2 pm (Closed Mon & Tues)

3. [Gyumon Halal Ramen](#)

 Asakusa

 **Why Go:** Halal-certified, offers **vegetarian ramen** too.

💰 ₹1400–₹2100 | ⌚ 12 pm–10 pm

4. [Maccha House](#)

 Shibuya

 **Why Go:** Famous for their **Uji Matcha Tiramisu**, a creamy, earthy dessert.

💰 ₹800–₹1200 | ⌚ 11 am–7 pm

 Vegetarian-friendly

5. [Le Souffle](#)

 Shibuya

 **Why Go:** Picture-perfect soufflés that are **light, airy, and indulgent**.

💰 ₹800–₹1200 | ⌚ 11 am–5:30 pm (Closed Mon & Tues)



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Must-Try Restaurants & Cafés in Kyoto

1. [Kyo Chabana Kyoto Station](#)



Near Kyoto Station



Why Go: Local favorite for **Kyoto-style Okonomiyaki** (ask for veg version).



₹1400–₹2100 | 5–10:30 pm

2. [Gohan-ya](#)



1 min from your hotel



Why Go: Cozy spot with seasonal home-cooked Japanese meals and **a massive sake selection**.



₹1000–₹1600 | 5:30–10:30 pm (Closed Sun)

3. [Fune Ethical Lifestyle Café](#)



15 min walk from hotel



Why Go: All-vegan menu; minimalist aesthetic; peaceful vibes.



₹800–₹1200 | 12–6 pm (Closed Wed)

4. [Kumonocha](#)



Kyoto



Why Go: Their **cloud-shaped mousse cakes** have gone viral. Also known for beautiful matcha creations.



₹800–₹1200 | 10 am–5:30 pm

5. [French Café Chasen](#)



Kyoto



Why Go: Their "kiribako" mist box reveals 8 **exquisite matcha desserts**—a visual and flavor treat.



₹800–₹1600 | 11 am–9 pm



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Must-Try Restaurants & Cafés in Osaka

1. [Green Earth](#)



Dotonbori



Why Go: Fully vegan Japanese and Western-style meals; **English-speaking staff.**



₹800–₹1200 | 11:30 am–5:00 pm (Closed Sun)

2. [Okonomiyaki Chitose](#)



20 min metro from hotel



Why Go: **Vegetarian Okonomiyaki**, made fresh in front of you with English menus.



₹800–₹1400 | 11:30 am–2 pm / 4:30–7 pm (Closed Tues & Wed)

3. [Tofu Sorano Minami Senba](#)



Near your hotel



Why Go: Specializes in **delicate tofu dishes**, from stews to handmade sets.



₹700–₹1000 | 11:30 am–3:30 pm, 5–10:30 pm

4. [Picco Latte](#)



Osaka



Why Go: A whimsical café full of **floral-themed drinks and desserts**—very Instagrammable.



₹800–₹1200 | 11 am–6 pm

5. [Ralph's Café Shinsaibashi](#)



Osaka



Why Go: Signature **Salted Caramel Espresso Milkshake** and stylish Ralph Lauren interiors.



₹600–₹1000 | 10 am–7 pm



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Must-Try Dishes in Japan

- Tempura- The batter-coated seafood and vegetables are traditionally fried in sesame oil and served with either a tiny pool of salt or a dish of soy sauce-flavoured broth spiked with grated radish for dipping
- Okonomiyaki is a type of Japanese savoury pancake. made by mixing together batter, sliced cabbage, and other savoury ingredients; spooning the mixture onto a hot plate; and then pan-frying as you would a pancake.
- Sushi- raw fish served on rice seasoned lightly with vinegar.
- Sashimi is raw fish or meat that has been expertly cut into thin slices and typically comes served with daikon radish, pickled ginger, wasabi and soy sauce.
- Onigiri - Triangular onigiri rice balls are a quintessential Japanese snack- Also known as 'omusubi', 'nigirimeshi', or just 'rice balls', onigiri are portions of Japanese rice, normally with a filling in the centre, that have been moulded into triangular or cylindrical shapes before being wrapped in nori seaweed.
- Ramen- egg noodles in a salty, meat based broth
- Udon noodles- One of the three main noodle varieties eaten in Japan. thick, chewy, and traditionally made from wheat flour and brine water. Udon can be served in a number of different ways (mixed into stir fries, added to hot pots, served cold with a tsuyu or tentsuyu soup base on the side for dipping), but are most commonly used in noodle soups
- Soba- long, thin buckwheat noodles. The noodles are served in either a hot, soy sauce-flavoured broth, or at room temperature on a bamboo mat with broth on the side for dipping.
- Unagi- river eel, usually grilled over charcoal and lacquered with a sweet barbecue sauce.
- Gyoza- savoury moon-shaped dumplings, made from a minced mixture of savoury fillings (pork mince, cabbage, green onion and mushroom is a common combination)
- Mochi- Wonderfully chewy and stretchy, mochi rice cakes are made from pounded steamed rice and often stuffed with sweet bean paste. You can find all kinds of delicious varieties, from sticky sakura mochi to strawberry daifuku mochi, each made with entirely plant-based ingredients.
- Wagashi- More like works of art than food, wagashi sweets are an unmissable Japanese treat. Traditionally made with only plant-based ingredients such as bean paste, they're beautifully crafted in the shape of flowers and other stunning designs. For a truly authentic experience, enjoy them with a cup of matcha tea!
- Shabu-shabu is the Japanese onomatopoeia for the sound of thin slices of beef or pork being swished around with chopsticks in bubbling broth
- Tonkatsu- breaded and deep-fried pork cutlet
- Yakitori- small skewers of bite-size chicken pieces seasoned with salt or brushed with a sauce, or tare, of mirin rice wine, soy sauce, sake alcohol, and sugar.
- Donburi- Donburi is made by preparing (normally by simmering or frying) various meat, fish and vegetables and serving over steamed rice in large bowls (also called 'donburi').
- Tamagoyaki- A versatile delicacy that can be enjoyed for breakfast, lunch, or dinner, tamagoyaki (which literally means 'cooked egg') is a Japanese omelette made by



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sequentially cooking and rolling up several layers of beaten egg (sometimes seasoned with soy sauce and/or sugar).

- Kashi Pan- the word 'kashipan' means 'sweet bread', and it refers to a range of single-serve bread buns that were originally invented in Japan. Among the most popular of these are melon pan (a bread bun with a cookie dough top), an pan (a bread bun filled with anko; a sweet red bean paste), and karee pan or kare pan (a bread bun filled with curry sauce, covered in panko breadcrumbs, and deep-fried). Kashipan are a must-try for bread lovers in particular.
- Miso Soup- Made from a combination of miso paste (a traditional Japanese food made from fermented soy beans) and dashi broth, miso soup is served as a side dish with traditional Japanese-style breakfasts, lunches and dinners.
- Mentaiko- This salty delicacy is made by marinating the roe (fish eggs) of pollock and cod in any of a number of salty, savoury, and spicy seasonings
- Nikujaga- A flavoursome savoury dish of meat, potatoes and assorted vegetables simmered in soy sauce, sake, mirin and sugar,
- Curry Rice- Japanese curry differs from the Indian varieties with which the UK is more familiar, in that it is generally sweeter in flavour, thicker in texture, and prepared more like a stew (with meat and vegetables being cooked by boiling in water together).
- Shabu Shabu hot pot- made by boiling vegetables, tofu and other ingredients in a mellow broth seasoned with kombu kelp, and then dipping very thin slices of meat into the broth and swishing the meat around until it cooks (normally around 10-20 seconds)
- Yakisoba- fried noodle dish made by barbecuing or stir-frying a combination of noodles, sliced cabbage, pork, carrot and other vegetables, and a barbecue style yakisoba sauce.
- Chawanmushi- This steamed, savoury egg custard is made by pouring seasoned, beaten eggs into individual cups already filled with different meats and vegetables (including chicken, mushrooms, ginkgo nuts, kamaboko fish cakes, and carrots), and then steaming the cups in a pot or steamer until they have solidified and become similar to pudding in texture.
- Wagashi- Wagashi are traditional Japanese sweets, invented during the Edo period and influenced by prevalent Japanese ingredients and flavours. Most wagashi are made using only a handful of select ingredients, including mochi rice cakes, anko paste, kanten (agar; a vegetarian thickener similar to gelatine), chestnuts, and sugar.



Must-Try Vegetarian Dishes in Japan

- Tempura- deep fried vegetables in batter
- Ukemono or Japanese pickled vegetables are an essential part of a Japanese meal and are always included in set meals.



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- Miso soup (often with tofu and green onions) is part of every set meal including breakfast. Chopsticks are used to eat the ingredients and the broth is sipped directly from the bowl.
- Zaru Soba- Cold soba (buckwheat) noodles are popular in the summer served on a bamboo tray with nori seaweed, spring onion, wasabi
- Okonomiyaki is a type of Japanese savoury pancake. It is usually made with egg so please try the ones only at vegan restaurants.
- Nasu dengaku- This classic Japanese side dish consists of grilled eggplant cut into slices and coated with a delicious, rich miso glaze.
- Veg Sushi- lots of sushi in Japan is vegetarian. Look out for treats such as kappa maki (cucumber rolls), takuan maki (pickled daikon rolls) and inarizushi (rice stuffed inside deep-fried tofu pockets).
- Vegetarian onigiri- Triangular onigiri rice balls are a quintessential Japanese snack, and several of them are vegetarian. Keep an eye out for ones filled with kombu seaweed, umeboshi (pickled plum), and natto (fermented soybeans).
- Vegetarian ramen
- Veg udon noodles
- Veg gyoza (veg momos)
- Mochi- Wonderfully chewy and stretchy, mochi rice cakes are made from pounded steamed rice and often stuffed with sweet bean paste. You can find all kinds of delicious varieties, from sticky sakura mochi to strawberry daifuku mochi, each made with entirely plant-based ingredients.
- Wagashi- More like works of art than food, wagashi sweets are an unmissable Japanese treat. Traditionally made with only plant-based ingredients such as bean paste, they're beautifully crafted in the shape of flowers and other stunning designs. For a truly authentic experience, enjoy them with a cup of matcha tea!



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Additional Tips as Vegetarians in Japan

- You could try telling people that you are vegetarian (“Watashi wa bejitarian des”) but they probably won’t understand exactly what this means.
- It is better to instead say- “watashi wa niku toh sakana wo tabemasen” which means I don’t eat meat or fish.
- Download the Google Translate app and use the speech to text feature to communicate what you want to.
- You can also use the camera feature on Google Translate app to go through menus that may not be in English
- Avoid Dashi (a popular condiment used in dipping sauces) since it contains fish sauce
- Look out for Coco Ichibanya- japans largest curry chain- which is available in most places and use the green menus (veg) to order.



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Japan Packing Guidelines (May Edition)



Clothing Essentials

Japan in May enjoys pleasant spring weather:

- **Tokyo/Kyoto/Osaka avg:** 13°C to 23°C
- **Mt. Fuji area:** cooler, especially in the early morning and late evening



What to Pack:

- 2–3 light **layers** (light sweaters, cardigans, long-sleeve shirts)
- 1 **light jacket** (especially for Mt. Fuji)
- 4–5 breathable **t-shirts/tops**
- 2 pairs of **comfortable pants/jeans**
- 1–2 **modest outfits** for temple visits (no sleeveless tops or short skirts)
- A set of **dressy casuals** (for high-end dinners or tea ceremony)
- 1 **compact umbrella** – occasional spring showers
- 1 **cap or hat** + **sunglasses** – for sunny days
- **Sleepwear**, undergarments, and socks



Footwear:

- 1 pair of **comfortable walking shoes** (lots of walking daily)
- 1 pair of **slip-on shoes** (easy for temples, hotel, airport)
- Optional: 1 pair of **dress shoes or sandals**



Tech & Travel Essentials





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- **Universal power adapter** (Japan uses Type A/B plugs, 100V)
- **Power bank**
- **Phone charger**
- Headphones/earbuds
- **Japanese SIM card**- our recommendation is NTT Docomo (best to get at the airport)



- Compact camera or phone with good storage (you'll want *tons* of photos at scenic spots like Mt. Fuji, Fushimi Inari, Arashiyama)



Travel Documents & Finance



Keep handy:

- Passport (with Japan visa)
- Travel Insurance – *TATA AIG* recommended
- Hotel booking confirmations
- Copies of flight tickets
- Currency (carry some **cash in yen**) and a **forex card** (e.g. BookMyForex)
- Emergency contacts & itinerary printout



- **ICOCA / Suica / Pasma card** – recommended for public transport. Load with ¥5000 to start.(pick this up at the metro station closest to your hotel)
- Credit card and/or travel card



Medicines & Toiletries



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- Basic medication kit (headache, cold, digestive issues, motion sickness)
- Any **prescription medications** (carry doctor's note)
- Band-aids/blister pads for walking
- Sunscreen, lip balm
- Insect repellent
- Hand sanitizer + wet wipes
- Toothbrush, toothpaste, mini toiletries

 **TIP:** Japanese pharmacies are amazing for skincare and daily needs—only bring what you truly need for transit days.



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Important Travel Tips

- Japan is very safe, but you should still **carry your passport at all times** (ID checks are mandatory for tourists at some attractions).
 - **Don't overpack.** You'll be shopping a lot (and trust us—Japan's shopping is incredible).
 - Bring a **separate bag or expandable suitcase** for souvenirs.
-



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Cultural Etiquette Guide: Japan

✅ What to Do

- **Greet with a bow** — polite and respectful.
 - **Remove shoes** at homes, temples, traditional restaurants, and sometimes changing rooms.
 - Use **both hands** when offering or receiving items, especially business cards or gifts.
 - Be **quiet in public transport**, especially trains.
 - Line up in an **orderly queue**—Japan is extremely orderly.
 - Carry a **small bag for your trash**—public bins are rare.
 - Use **polite phrases**, even if just a few words.
-

❌ What to Avoid

- Don't **talk on the phone** inside trains or buses.
 - Avoid public displays of affection (hand-holding is okay; kissing isn't).
 - Don't **tip**—it can actually be considered rude.
 - Don't point at people or objects.
 - Never stick chopsticks **upright in rice**—it resembles a funeral ritual.
-



Common Phrases (with pronunciation)

- Hello – *Konnichiwa* (kohn-nee-chee-wah)
- Thank you – *Arigatou gozaimasu* (ah-ree-gah-toh goh-zah-ee-mas)



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- Excuse me / Sorry – *Sumimasen* (soo-mee-mah-sen)
- Yes – *Hai* | No – *Īe*
- Bill, please – *Okaikei onegaishimasu*
- I don't eat meat or fish – *Watashi wa niku to sakana wo tabemasen*

➡ **Download Google Translate** – use the camera or speech tools when needed.

Souvenir Shopping Guide: What to Buy & Where

Traditional & Cultural

- **Chopsticks, Senu Fans, Woodblock Prints** – Tokyu Hands, Loft (Tokyo/Osaka), Daiso
 - **Goshuincho (Temple Stamp Book)** – Buy at each temple, beautiful keepsake
 - **Maneki-neko (Lucky Cat)** – Souvenir and temple shops
 - **Omamori (Amulets for luck/protection)** – At all temples, each shrine has a unique one
-

Food & Consumables

- **Wagashi & Mochi (Sweets)** – Izutsu shops, supermarkets
 - **Yatsushashi (Kyoto specialty)** – Cinnamon-flavored mochi
 - **Green Tea (Matcha, Hojicha, Sencha)** – Ippodo, Tsujiri, Fukujien
 - **KitKat Unique Flavors** – Don Quijote, KitKat Chocolatory stores
 - **Japanese Sake / Umeshu** – Department stores like Isetan, Daimaru
-



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Cool, Modern & Edgy

- **Anime Goods, Pokémon, Nintendo, Jump Store merch** – Akihabara, Shibuya, Kyoto Teramachi, Osaka Namba
- **Japanese Skincare & Beauty** – Cosme Tokyo, local pharmacies, Shu Uemura (Omotesando)
- **Kawaii Stationery** – Tokyu Hands, Loft, Kinokuniya, Daiso
- **Uniqlo & GU clothing** – Large branches in Tokyo, Kyoto & Osaka

 *Tip:* Always ask for **tax-free** shopping (bring your passport), especially at large chain stores.

Personal Safety & Emergency Tips

General Safety

- Japan is one of the safest countries globally, but:
 - Keep valuables zipped up in crowded places (Shibuya, Dotonbori)
 - Avoid deserted alleys late at night
 - Be aware of “bar scams” in nightlife districts
-

Emergency Contacts

-  **Police:** 110
 -  **Ambulance/Fire:** 119
 -  **Indian Embassy Tokyo**
Tel: +81-3-3262-2391 | Address: 2-2-11 Kudan Minami, Chiyoda-ku, Tokyo
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Health & Vaccination Advice



Recommended Vaccinations (for most travelers)

- Hepatitis A
- Hepatitis B
- Typhoid
- Routine vaccines (MMR, DPT, influenza)

If planning outdoor rural trips, **Japanese Encephalitis** is sometimes advised, but not necessary for your city-based itinerary.



Medication Tips

- **Prescription meds:** Carry a copy of your doctor's prescription.
 - Japan restricts some over-the-counter meds (e.g., those with pseudoephedrine). Carry only necessary quantities and check with your airline/customs if unsure.
-

Absolutely! Here's your final set of **on-the-go essentials**, including SIM card tips, must-have apps, and **important places around your hotels** for quick grocery or pharmacy runs.



Mobile Connectivity in Japan



Getting a SIM Card

Best Option: NTT Docomo – Offers excellent coverage across Tokyo, Kyoto, Osaka, and even rural areas like Mt. Fuji.



Buy your SIM card:



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- At the airport (most reliable)
- Major electronic stores (e.g., BIC Camera, Yodobashi)
- Select convenience stores

Prepaid SIMs or eSIMs are available with:

- Unlimited data (usually capped at high speed after a threshold)
- No ID needed, but you'll need an **unlocked phone**

eSIM services to consider: Airalo, Ubigi, Sakura Mobile



Roaming Tips

- Even if not using international roaming, **keep your Indian number active** to receive OTPs and bank messages.
 - Use Wi-Fi at your hotels and train stations to save data.
-



Must-Have Apps

1. **Google Maps** – Best for navigation, including local transit
2. **Google Translate** – Use voice and camera features for real-time translations
3. **Klook / GetYourGuide** – Manage attraction tickets & bookings
4. **Go Taxi** – Book taxis when public transport isn't feasible
5. **HappyCow** – Discover vegetarian/vegan restaurants nearby



Tip: Pre-download Google Maps offline areas for Tokyo, Kyoto, Osaka.



Important Places Around Your Hotels



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Richmond Hotel Premier Tokyo Schole

-  [Family Mart, Sumida](#) – 3 min walk | Open 24/7
 -  [Pharmacy near Hikifune Station](#) – 2 min walk | Open 9:00 am – 9:00 pm
 -  [San-ikukai Hospital](#) – 3 min drive
 -  [Tokyo Hikifune Hospital](#) – 3 min drive
-

Richmond Hotel Premier Kyoto Ekimae

-  [7-Eleven - Shimogyō Ward Office](#) – 2 min walk | Open 24/7
 -  [Hanshin Pharmacy Kizuyabashi](#) – 2 min walk | Open 9:00 am – 9:00 pm
 -  [Koseikai Takeda Hospital](#) – 2 min walk
-

Thank You!

Thank you for giving us the opportunity to plan your vacation. We hope you fully enjoy your vacation and make unforgettable memories for a lifetime!

Don't forget, we're just a message or call away for any assistance you may need, whether it's before, during, or after your trip.

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